

RESTRICTED - HR Only

Harbourline Energy Co.

Workplace Investigation Protocol

Field	Value
Document ID	HR-RST-103
Version	2.0
Effective date	2025-05-01
Policy owner	Hamid Qureshi, Director, Employee Relations
Approved by	Andrew Kim, General Counsel
Applies to	Human Resources investigators and approved external investigators
Next scheduled review	2026-04-30
Classification	Restricted, HR group only

1. Purpose

This protocol sets the internal standard for planning and conducting workplace investigations into harassment, discrimination, violence, misconduct and Code of Conduct complaints.

2. Triage and Assignment

Every complaint is triaged within 2 business days by the Director, Employee Relations, and given an investigation number in the format INV-YYYY-NNN. Triage decides whether the matter is investigated internally, externally, or resolved informally.

Situation	Investigator
Respondent below Director level	Trained HR investigator from another region
Respondent is Director or above	External investigator engaged through Legal
Complaint involves an HR employee	External investigator engaged through Legal
Possible criminal conduct	Legal and Corporate Security jointly; police may be notified

3. Conduct of the Investigation

- Target completion for an internal investigation is 45 calendar days from assignment, well inside the 90-day outer target published in HR-POL-031. Any extension is approved by the Director, Employee Relations, and the parties are informed.
- The standard of proof is the balance of probabilities.
- Interviews are conducted by two people (investigator and note taker). Audio recording is not permitted.
- Witness statements are reviewed and signed by the witness within 3 business days of the interview.
- Interim measures (schedule changes, paid administrative leave) may be applied during the investigation and do not imply a finding.

4. Evidence and Records

All evidence is stored in the restricted ER-Vault library with access limited to the investigator, the Director, Employee Relations, and Legal. Investigation files are retained for 7 years after closure, or longer if litigation is pending. Email searches require written approval from the General Counsel.

5. Reporting

The investigator issues a confidential report with findings (substantiated, not substantiated, or inconclusive) within 5 business days of the last interview. The complainant and respondent receive a written summary of results, not the full report.

6. Related Documents

- Disciplinary Case Handling Procedure (HR-RST-101)
- Workplace Harassment and Violence Prevention Policy, Ontario (HR-POL-031)
- Code of Business Conduct (HR-POL-001)

7. Revision History

Version	Date	Author	Summary of changes
1.0	2022-05-01	Employee Relations	Initial protocol.
1.1	2023-11-01	Hamid Qureshi	ER-Vault introduced for evidence storage.
2.0	2025-05-01	Hamid Qureshi	Target completion reduced from 60 to 45 days; audio recording prohibited.